

Kyle Cuss

Gameplay / Systems Engineer

Contact



cussprogramming@gmail.com



www.linkedin.com/in/kyle-cuss



https://github.com/Cussk



https://cussk.github.io/kylecuss.com

Summary

Gameplay and systems engineer with 3+ years of professional experience developing games in Unreal Engine (C++) and Unity (C#). Specializes in building scalable gameplay systems, multiplayer gameplay architecture, AI systems, and data-driven frameworks.

Experienced in designing modular gameplay subsystems, optimizing performance in complex gameplay environments, and collaborating with distributed teams to deliver production-quality features. Passionate about creating maintainable systems that support rapid iteration and long-term scalability.

Skills

Game Engines

Unreal Engine 5 (C++ / Blueprints), Unity (C#)

Gameplay & Systems Engineering

Gameplay Systems Architecture, Multiplayer Gameplay Programming, AI Systems (Behavior Trees, StateTree, Perception), Subsystem-Based Architecture, Data-Driven Gameplay Frameworks

Technical Systems

Replication & Networked Gameplay, Performance Optimization, Object Pooling, Event-Driven Systems, Dependency Injection

Programming Languages

C++, C#, Python, GDScript, Javascript

Tools & Workflow

Perforce, Diversion, Git, Azure DevOps, Jira/Trello, Agile Development

Experience

Gameplay / Systems Engineer - RED Gaming | 2025 - Present

Gameplay and systems engineering for Bedroom Brawl, a multiplayer Unreal Engine title currently in development.

- Designed and implemented modular gameplay subsystems supporting progression, objectives, and match systems.
- Developed AI gameplay systems using Behavior Trees, StateTree, and AI Perception, enabling dynamic enemy behaviors and strategic decision making.
- Built scalable player progression and currency systems, including persistent profile data and reward structures.
- Implemented multiplayer gameplay systems and replication logic across GameMode, GameState, and PlayerState layers.
- Designed objective scoring and event systems used across multiple game modes.
- Built systems supporting tower defense gameplay, including trap placement, grid management, wave spawning, and enemy pathing.
- Improved runtime performance through subsystem-driven architecture, object pooling, and reduced actor tick overhead.
- Collaborated with engineering and design teams to translate gameplay concepts into scalable C++ systems.

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Experience

Freelance Gameplay / Systems Engineer | 2024 - Present

Provide gameplay and systems engineering support for multiple independent game development projects.

- Developed gameplay systems and UI features using Unity (C#) and Unreal Engine (C++).
- Implemented player input, UI navigation systems, and gameplay interactions based on client design specifications.
- Integrated new gameplay systems into existing project frameworks and asset pipelines.
- Delivered modular gameplay code designed for rapid iteration in small team environments.
- Provided technical recommendations on gameplay system architecture and implementation.

Game Engineer (Contract) - *Wamba World* | July 2023 - Aug 2025

Developer on Waffle Smash: Diner Rush, a mobile match-3 and diner management game released on Android and iOS.

- Implemented core gameplay features including match-3 mechanics, diner systems, UI, and progression systems.
- Integrated Unity Addressables with Play Asset Delivery (PAD) to support on-demand asset streaming.
- Reduced memory usage and initial download size through dynamic asset loading and unloading systems.
- Developed data-driven scene management and tutorial systems using Scriptable Objects and dependency injection.
- Maintained the Android build pipeline and Google Play Store publishing process.
- Led Unity engine upgrades and resolved dependency conflicts across packages.
- Collaborated with design and art teams to rapidly iterate on gameplay systems.

Gameplay Programmer (Voluntary) - *Greatsword Games* | 2023

Worked on an Unreal Engine MMORPG prototype.

- Refactored prototype Blueprint ability systems into C++ using Unreal's Gameplay Ability System (GAS).
- Improved multiplayer replication reliability and long-term scalability.
- Collaborated with the engineering team to migrate prototype gameplay systems into production-ready architecture.

Projects

Technical project breakdowns and case studies available at:

<https://cussk.github.io/kylecuss.com>

Education

Unity

Dec 2022

Skills for Hire Atlantic

Dec 2022

McMaster University

2011

Unity Learn

Unity Junior Programmer, Unity Creative Core, Unity Essentials

Web Development Bootcamp

Certificate of Completion

Batchelor of Arts

Anthropology
